

- **Performance Testing**

Performance testing is done to identify the issues that hamper the performance of the software. The software is tested for speed, stability, capacity, and scalability. For example, network delay, delay in database accessing, and data rendering.

- **Load Testing**

It is a type of performance testing where the behaviour of the software is tested by applying the maximum load to find the maximum capacity and behaviour of the software at maximum load. This type of testing is performed using automated tools like Visual Studio Load Test, Apache JMeter, Load Runner, etc.

- **Stress Testing**

It is another type of performance testing where the behaviour of the software is tested against abnormal or unusual conditions to identify the breaking points. A condition such as a database start/shutdown, network ports open/close, etc. are tested.

- **Usability Testing**

Usability testing is a black box testing where the software is tested by end-users to find errors or improvements in the software. A set of users tests the software thoroughly to check if the software is easy to use and they can complete the tasks. The main goal of this testing is to identify gaps in the design as early as possible so that they can be fixed in time before the team plans for mass production. Testers give a series of tasks to the end-users that they need to complete by interacting with the software and records or analyzes their responses or reactions.

What are the skills needed to become a software tester?

Here is a list of a few skills that a tester must possess to grow in their career:

- **Software testing techniques:** A certification in testing is always beneficial when you apply for a job as a tester. ISTQB foundation level certificate is one of the basic certificates that one can go for. knowledge of programming language helps in understanding and reviewing the code to understand the application or software workflow and find defects at the early stages.
- **Software testing tools:** A tester should have knowledge of several testing tools to track defects, manage, and run various test cases. A